

Figure 4.2 *Shah-i Mashhad* madrasa *and Murghab River. © Google Earth 2018.*



Figure 4.3 *Shah-i Mashhad* madrasa *on Google Earth, detail with superimposed plan (from Najimi 2015: 153). © David Thomas 2018.*

Mashhad's precise *qibla* – achieved by hypothetically rotating the complex several degrees further counterclockwise – M. Casimir and B. Glatzer declared this "distinct deviation … a problem which … has not been sufficiently examined."[36] Thankfully, during the intervening years since Casimir and Glatzer's initial rediscovery of and publications on the site, scholars such as David King have examined this "problem" extensively, providing